

Ἄνυμος ὕμνος εἰς τοὺς Ἰδαίους Δακτύλους

Hymn to the Idaean Dactyls by an Anonymous Roman-Era Poet

eul_aid: rgw

Period: [Ῥωμαϊκή](#) [Roman](#)
Dialect: [Ἑπική](#) [Epic](#) ([Homeric](#))
Domain: [Ποίησις](#) [Poetry](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

The Hymn to the Idaean Dactyls is an anonymous hexameter hymn preserved within the corpus of the Homeric Hymns. This 16-line invocation is addressed to the Dactyls of Mount Ida. Composed in Homeric Greek, it likely dates from the Roman era, between the second and fourth centuries CE, reflecting the enduring adaptation of archaic mythological figures.

The poem addresses the Dactyls as skilled artisans in the service of the Muses and Hephaestus, crediting them with the discovery of iron-working in the woods of Ida. As a cult hymn, it combines praise with an etiological function, concluding with a plea for gladness and peace from these deities.

It survives as part of the later manuscript tradition of the Homeric Hymns, primarily in the 15th-century codex Matritensis 4561. Its significance lies in its role as a concise literary source for the Dactyls, mythical beings linked to metallurgy and mystery cults, illustrating the perpetuation of their lore into the Roman period.

Works (1)

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